

Your First 90 Days on the Board



Guidance, Structure, and Collaboration from the Very Beginning

The first 90 days lay the foundation for a successful Toastmasters year. Those who establish clarity early on—regarding roles, goals, and collaboration—lay the groundwork for a well-functioning club where joy replaces frustration.

Schedule

Week 1-2	Week 3-4	Month 2	Month 3
Kickoff & Getting to Know Each Other	Role & Clarity	Planning & Structure	Operation & Rhythm
Kick-Off physisch, Regeln festlegen, Überblick über Termine verschaffen	Club Leadership Handbook, Role Coordination	CSP Club Success Plan, DCP Goals	Planning Club Nights and Competitions

Key Points at a Glance

1	Prepare for the handoff - Plan individual handoffs for each officer position and begin parallel operations in June (old/new officers) - Set up the technical requirements (accounts, passwords, email forwarding, website updates, etc.) - Ideally: Hand over the club handbook containing the club's collective knowledge and specific details (don't always reinvent the wheel—it's better to build on what's already there!) - Don't forget to reserve a room and post the dates. Inventory and Reordering of Materials (flip chart, evaluation forms, pins, pennants, pens...)	2	Kick-Off: Plan the First Board Meeting - Ideally, meet in person → Get to know each other and build trust (TMs are only human, after all 😊) Workshop Format: Collaboratively exploring topics in an interactive way - Discuss and establish rules for collaboration (e.g., clarify communication channels, WhatsApp groups, email, decision-making processes) - Agree on the club's vision and goals together (see also CSP) - Set up document storage (e.g., gDrive or OneDrive)
3	Role Clarification & Handbook for Club Leadership - Review and adjust individual role descriptions - Define areas of authority and responsibilities, and, if necessary, create assistant roles to lighten the load on certain roles → Tip: Use the Club Leadership Handbook as a guide - Define the onboarding process for new members; clarify the rules for designating substitutes	4	Organize regular board meetings - Determine the frequency (ideally monthly) well in advance - Recommended: Meet in person at least once per quarter Web conferences are better than phone calls; you can show people a lot more - Gather topics in advance, keep meetings efficient, record decisions promptly, and keep club members updated (ideally: centrally in the cloud, e.g., Google Docs, Google Drive)
5	Club Success Plan (CSP) and Distinguished Club Program (DCP) Points - Develop and submit a club success plan (by September 30) Assessment of the Club ("Key Moments") - Understanding the DCP Program and Setting Goals Special Evening: Discussing Club Night Variations (Tutorials...)	6	Clarify the dates for the year - Create a club calendar and enter all important dates - Club Nights: Coordinating with Holidays and School Breaks
7	Key Dates for the First Half of the Year (July–December) - July: 1st Club Officer Training (around July, all officers) - July: Introductory Workshop for VPE, Pathways Workshop (important!) - Sept: Transfer of membership dues (half-year: Oct–March) - Oct/Nov: Registration Opens for the District Conference - Dec: Christmas party (e.g., with a Secret Santa exchange or similar) - Celebrate the club's anniversary (also plan a summer party →)	8	Key Dates for the Second Half of the Year (Dec–July) - Jan: 2nd Club Officer Training (approx. Jan/Feb, all officers) - Feb: Plan competitions (Club~Feb., Area~March, Div.~Apr) - March: Transfer of membership dues (half-year: April–September) - March: Encourage members to become successor officers - May: District Committee Meetings (DCM) (primarily VPE/Pres.) - May: Officer Elections (entry in Easyspeak, at TMI) - May/June: Final Push for DCP Points - June/July: Order materials from TMI (PINs, badges, etc.)
9	Have fun... - You learn three times as fast when you're having fun! - Serving in an officer's position teaches you things you would rarely learn otherwise	Be proud and celebrate being a Toastmaster! 😊	

"The first 90 days aren't a sprint—they're the start of a wonderful journey together."

⚠ **Beware of rash action:** Don't try to "change everything" right away. First, understand what works—that is, listen, organize, adapt, and refine.